



We do not need the answer yet. First, let us find a way in!

MISSION: How much time passed?

The problem

Amira starts at 3:30 p.m. and finishes at 5:15 p.m. How much time passed?

CLUE 1 - What is the problem asking you to find?

Say it in your own words. No math yet.

CLUE 2 - What do you KNOW that might help?

Write any useful facts or easy times you notice. You do not have to know the whole plan yet.

YOUR FIRST PATH - What will you try?

Draw, write, make jumps, or use numbers. Your path can be messy.

THINKING TOKENS



I understood it



I found a clue



I tried a path



Only uncover the next hint if you are really stuck. Trying first earns a Thinking Token!

Use hints one at a time.

Tip for printing: cover each hint with a sticky note or a strip of scrap paper. Reveal only the next one you need.

HINT 1 - NOTICE

Are there any nice, easy clock times between 3:30 and 5:15?

HINT 2 - FIND AN ANCHOR

Would 4:00 or 5:00 be useful places to stop on the way?

HINT 3 - BREAK IT INTO JUMPS

Try making small time jumps from 3:30 toward 5:15. Write the minutes for each jump.

HINT 4 - TRY THIS START

How many minutes from 3:30 to 4:00? What could you do next?

BACK TO YOUR PATH

Now try again. What did the hint help you notice?



Nice detective work! Build the path first. The answer comes after.

1. Show your path

Circle, draw arrows, write jumps, or explain it in words.

2. Your answer

How much time passed?

3. Another door?

Can you think of a different way to reach the same answer? If not, that is okay - ask a grown-up to show you one after you explain your own path.

My second idea:

4. Choose the Thinking Moves you used

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Found an anchor | ☐ Broke it into parts |
| ☐ Tried before I was sure | ☐ Checked my idea |

Purpose of this mission

This is a reasoning exercise disguised as a time problem. The goal is for Amira to understand the question, find a foothold, try a path, and revise if needed. Do not rush to teach clock subtraction.

What to praise

- "You found a useful anchor."
- "You broke a big problem into smaller pieces."
- "You tried something even before you knew it would work."
- "You checked your idea and changed it."

Answer

1 hour 45 minutes (105 minutes).

Valid reasoning paths to recognize

Anchor at 4:00 and 5:00

3:30 → 4:00 = 30 min; 4:00 → 5:00 = 60 min; 5:00 → 5:15 = 15 min. Total = 105 min.

Overshoot and come back

3:30 → 5:30 = 2 hours. But 5:15 is 15 minutes before 5:30, so 2 hours - 15 minutes = 1 hour 45 minutes.

One-hour block first

3:30 → 4:30 = 1 hour, then 4:30 → 5:15 = 45 minutes. Total = 1 hour 45 minutes.

If she gets stuck

Ask: "What is one thing you know for sure?" or "Is there an easy time between the two times?" Give the next hint only after she has had a chance to try.